SUKANYA SAMRIDDHI YOJANA (SSY) - GIRL CHILD SAVINGS SCHEME

1. SCHEME OVERVIEW

Sukanya Samriddhi Yojana (SSY) is a small savings scheme launched on 22 January 2015 under the 'Beti Bachao Beti Padhao' campaign of the Government of India. Administered by the Ministry of Finance through Post Offices and authorised banks, SSY provides a high-interest, tax-exempt savings account for the welfare, higher education, and marriage expenses of girl children.

2. ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Who can open an SSY account:

- Account can be opened only in the name of a girl child below 10 years of age.
- Only the natural or legal guardian (parent) can open and operate the account.
- Maximum of 2 SSY accounts per family (one per girl child).
- Exception: A 3rd account is allowed if twin or triplet girls are born in the 2nd birth.
- Girl child must be an Indian citizen and resident in India.
- NRIs (Non-Resident Indians) are NOT eligible to open SSY accounts.

3. INTEREST RATE AND DEPOSIT RULES

Current Interest Rate (FY 2024-25): 8.2% per annum, compounded annually.
This is one of the highest interest rates among all Government small savings schemes.

Deposit Rules:

- Minimum deposit per year: Rs 250.
- Maximum deposit per year: Rs 1,50,000.
- Deposits must be made for 15 years from the date of account opening.
- Account matures after 21 years from opening OR at marriage after age 18 (whichever is earlier).
- Partial withdrawal: Up to 50% of account balance allowed after girl turns 18 years old, for higher education expenses only.

4. TAX BENEFITS - EEE STATUS

SSY enjoys complete Triple-E (Exempt-Exempt-Exempt) tax status:

- Contributions (Deposits): Eligible for tax deduction under Section 80C of the Income Tax Act, up to Rs 1.5 lakh per financial year.
- Interest Earned: Completely tax-exempt under Section 10 of the Income Tax Act.
- Maturity Amount (Withdrawal): Fully tax-exempt at the time of withdrawal.

This Triple-E status makes SSY one of the most tax-efficient savings instruments available to Indian taxpayers for girl child welfare.

5. ACCOUNT OPENING AND PREMATURE CLOSURE RULES

Where to open SSY account:

- Any Post Office (Head Post Office or Sub Post Office) across India.
- Authorised banks: SBI, PNB, Bank of Baroda, Canara Bank, and all major banks.

Documents Required:
- Birth certificate of girl child.
- Aadhaar card of parent/guardian.
- Address proof and photograph.

Premature Closure Allowed only in these cases:
- Death of the account holder (girl child) - full corpus returned.
- Life-threatening medical condition of account holder.
- Marriage of girl after attaining 18 years (1 month advance notice required).

Default Account Revival: If minimum deposit not made, pay Rs 50 penalty per year of default plus the minimum deposit amount to revive the account.
Post Office Helpline: 1800-11-2211 (Toll Free).